

1. Giving and taking credit in big tech companies

Source: seangoedecke.com RSS feed | Published: Sun, 02 Aug 2026 00:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://seangoedecke.com/giving-and-taking-credit/>

Engineers often complain that visibility should be their manager's job. In other words, they think engineers should be able to focus on the code, while their manager figures out who's doing well and rewards them. This attitude is an extension of the 'school fantasy': the idea that your workplace should operate by the same rules as your school or university. After all, you didn't have to worry about 'visibility' during your education. You simply did the assignments and tests you were given, and if you did well you were rewarded with a good grade. Many big tech companies encourage this attitude, because it helps them recruit smart graduates. They fashion their workplaces to look and feel like a university, even calling the physical space 'campuses'. But it's still work, not school. If you treat it like school, you are going to have a bad time. Taking credit The first lesson many new engineers learn is that you have to take credit for your work . If you silently jump in to help a struggling project and get it back on track, there's no guarantee of reward. Credit will naturally flow to the project lead, not you. In fact, if this project is outside of your direct team, it's likely you...

2. condense-json 1.0

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-08-02T22:19:59+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Aug/2/condense-json/#atom-everything>

Release: condense-json 1.0 I'm trying to get braver at releasing 1.0 versions. This little library is a year and a half old now - I've applied some sensible and non-disruptive fixes and shipped the big 1.0 for it. Here's an example of what it can do, lifted from the README: { "foo" : { "bar" : { "string" : " This is a string with foxes in it " , "nested" : { "more" : [" Here is a string " , " another with foxes in it too "] } } } } Combine that with a replacements object: { "1" : " with foxes in it " } And condense_json(input_json, replacements) produces the following: { "foo" : { "bar" : { "string" : { "\$r" : [" This is a string " , { "\$" : " 1 "] } } , "nested" : { "more" : [" Here is a string " , { "\$r" : [" another " , { "\$" : " 1 " } , " too "] }] } } } } It scans for strings or substrings that are present in that replacements object and replaces those with a special { "\$r": ... } syntax in the output. You can reverse the effect with uncondense_json(condensed, replacements) . The idea is to make it easier to store JSON that includes duplicated data from other related structures. I use it to save space in the SQLite logs generated by LLM - see PR #1586 for the latest iteration...

3. datasette-apps 0.2a0

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-08-01T21:23:56+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Aug/1/datasette-apps/#atom-everything>

Release: datasette-apps 0.2a0 Changes that improve Datasette Apps when created and edited using Datasette Agent : New app_debug() tool allowing agent to open an app (invisibly) and test it using JavaScript. #33 New app_list() tool for listing apps the user has permission to edit, so the agent can edit them. #36 The app_debug() tool is pretty neat: it works by displaying the app in a opacity: 0 iframe with pointer-events: none (so it can't be seen or interacted with) and then executing agent-provided JavaScript inside that sandboxed iframe. This means the agent can smoke test that the app is working and even do things like measure the dimensions of different elements. This uses the new context.browser_task() mechanism added in datasette-agent 0.4a0 . Tags: iframes , datasette , datasette-apps

4. Ten advances in mathematics and theoretical computer science

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-08-01T20:34:49+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Aug/1/ten-advances-in-mathematics/#atom-everything>

Ten advances in mathematics and theoretical computer science A few days ago it was Anthropic discovering cryptographic weaknesses with Claude using Mythos Preview, spending \$100,000 on

tokens and with prompts that included "again we are not looking for low hanging fruit, we want proper research to find genuinely hard findings." Now it's OpenAI's turn to flex. They set "an internal version of Astra, our next major model" on finding solutions to ten mathematical problems that "have seen no progress on the main result for at least a decade". They claim to have spent less than \$2,000 at GPT-5.6 Sol token prices on each one. (No news on how many problems they spent \$2,000 on without reaching a solution though.) The openai/ten-proofs repository has Lean 4 formalizations of their results, and there's also a paper describing the solutions and an additional LLM-generated PDF where the model "reconstructs how the proof came together" based on the unpublished reasoning traces. That's a decent level of transparency, but I want to see the prompts they used! A lot of mathematicians online are experiencing a collective burst of Deep Blue . Mathematician Kirwin Hampshire published an impassioned e...

5. Agent Fone

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-08-02T21:02:00Z

Link: <https://fail.xyz/phone/>

My thanks to Agent Fone for sponsoring last week at DF. Agent Fone is a crazily ambitious new smartphone that doesn't merely ship with a built-in AI assistant. Instead, the entire concept is that it enables you to create custom software, right on the phone itself. Ideas for new apps that you've had in your notes for years. Weird little app ideas that only you would want. Describe your idea, answer a few questions, and Agent Fone builds an app, or widget, and it's on your home screen. They're looking for 50 people and small teams to sell the first 50 hardware units to. If you're interested, check out their website for all the information you need, and broader description of the platform. ?

6. Boris Cherny on Trying to Get Claude Code to Rewrite the Claude App

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-08-02T21:01:12Z

Link: <https://www.ycrootaccess.com/p/boris-cherny-building-claude-code>

Boris Cherny, head of Claude Code at Anthropic, was interviewed by Diana Hu on stage at Y Combinator's Startup School 2026 last week. Starting around 20:30 in the video , he briefly discussed directing Claude to perform difficult tasks: Cherny: I think the skill nowadays is less about prompt engineering and more about figuring out how do you give Claude a hard task that seems a little bit too hard. Then how do you make it possible for Claude to verify its work along the way? The verification is probably the single most important thing that people do not get right, largely. One example of this is people were ? we have this desktop app for Claude and it's built using Electron. We've made it quite fast. Now it's a pretty awesome experience. Six months ago it was sluggish and it wasn't very reliable. Now it's pretty awesome. It's the thing that most of the team uses. As an experiment, I wanted to see what it would feel like if it was native. So what I did is I started a Claude Tag session. Claude Tag is a new product we have. It's just Claude running in Slack. My first question was, ?Hey Tag, do you have access to a Mac OS runner on GitHub?? It said no. Then I hooked up a runner. So i...

7. Count Those Underscores

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-07-29T15:28:02Z

Link: <https://arstechnica.com/tech-policy/2026/07/police-missed-one-underscore-and-sent-the-wrong-man-to-prison/>

Nate Anderson, reporting for Ars Technica under the headline ?A Missing Underscore Sent Innocent Man to Prison for 18 Months?: Police were looking for a man using the Kik messaging service under the name ?fus__ro_dah? (two underscores after ?fus?), but they accidentally requested records for the username ?fus_ro_dah? (one underscore after ?fus?). This one-character difference led them not to the perpetrator but to a Canadian man named Brandon Klayme. [...] Despite finding no evidence of the crime on his digital devices, Canadian police arrested Klayme in 2020 on child sex abuse charges. He was convicted after a trial in 2023 and sentenced in 2024 to 18 months in prison. He served the full term. Even after release, Klayme continued to fight his conviction. In the process of preparing his appeal, the username mistake

that led to all these years of disruption was finally discovered. On Thursday, the Nova Scotia Court of Appeal overturned Klayme's conviction, writing: "Mr. Klayme is factually innocent of the offences. He should never have been charged, let alone convicted." Via Paul Kafasis, who asks: While I understand how the mistake led to this poor guy becoming a suspect, I reall...

8. Holonomic functions

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Sun, 02 Aug 2026 20:47:53 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/08/02/holonomic-functions/>

Yesterday I wrote that a lot of the special functions that pop up in mathematical physics are solutions to second order linear differential equations with polynomial coefficients. More generally, holonomic functions are defined to be those functions that are the solutions to linear differential equations, of any order, with polynomial coefficients. Most special functions are [?] The post Holonomic functions first appeared on John D. Cook .

9. Estimating a cumulative sum

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Sun, 02 Aug 2026 17:57:31 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/08/02/estimating-a-cumulative-sum/>

In this post I mentioned two series which I denoted $t(n)$ and $c(n)$. The former is the number of unlabeled rooted trees with n nodes. The latter is the cumulative sum of the former, i.e. The sequence $c(n)$ is also the number of constraints on an n -step Runge-Kutta method; that's how I became interested in it. Now the $t(n)$ sequence [?] The post Estimating a cumulative sum first appeared on John D. Cook .

10. Review: Job-Less Utopia

Source: Fernando Borretti | Published: Mon, 03 Aug 2026 00:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://borretti.me/article/review-job-less-utopia>

Review of Marcus Hutter's Job-Less Utopia .

11. Mathematics Without Mathematicians

Source: Fernando Borretti | Published: Sun, 02 Aug 2026 00:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://borretti.me/article/mathematics-without-mathematicians>

We must know. We shall not know.

12. Weekly Update 515

Source: Troy Hunt | Published: Mon, 03 Aug 2026 00:07:14 GMT

Link: <https://www.troyhunt.com/weekly-update-515/>

Apparently, Aussies are so obsessed with coffee that it's referred to as the coffee capital of the world down here (some bits, at least). "But what about Italy?" people ask. Having spent a lot of time in a lot of Italy, no, it's just

13. telephones caught in between

Source: computers are bad | Published: 02 Aug 2026 00:00:00 UT

Link: <https://computer.rip/2026-08-02-telephone-leasing.html>

During the heyday of AT&T, it was often said that the telephone system was the largest machine ever built. The "hello machine" certainly was vast, but whether or not you consider it to be a single machine raises challenging questions of definition. The Internet, I think we can all agree, is not a single machine but a system of interconnected ones. The telephone network, though, felt a lot more like one device. "One Policy, One System, Universal Service" was once the slogan of AT&T, a message that the telephone network is more than just a sum of parts. The third of these principles, "Universal Service," is a key point around which telecom policy pivots even today. As the telephone system was at its apex, Universal Service became its undoing. We know the Internet to be a network of independent devices in part because of the wide variety of ways that we access it. Computer networks, almost to their origin, have emphasized independent implementations of standardized interfaces. Computers, as network nodes, are interchangeable. As a result, much of the complexity must be pushed to the edge, where

end-user systems are most able to adapt to the unique needs of, well, the end-user. The te...